Marvyn-Stephano Zalewski

Engineering Manager - Cloud Platform

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Summary

Engineering Manager with **10+ years** building and running cloud platforms, now leading the Cloud Platform and DevOps teams at Awin. I've led a datacenter-to-AWS migration, built a FinOps practice that saves **$1M+** a year, and moved teams to owning the systems they build. My focus is simpler infrastructure and a better developer experience, and I measure both.

German citizen and eligible to work across the EU.

Skills

Technologies: AWS, AWS MAP, AWS Backup, Terraform, Docker, GitLab CI/CD, GitHub Actions, GitHub Enterprise, Jira Service Management, Observability (logs/metrics/traces), FinOps, Datadog, CloudFormation, Ansible

Security: SPLC, AWS Security Hub, SCPs, IAM Identity Center, GuardDuty, RBAC, Risk Management, NIST, Incident Response, Application Security Assessments, PCI-DSS, ISO 27001

Programming: Python, Java, TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, Bun, Bash

Frameworks: Angular, React, NestJS, Next.js

Leadership: Hiring, Coaching and Mentoring, Feedback, Team Topologies, You Build It You Run It, SRE, ADRs, Psychological Safety, OKRs, Change Management, Remote and Cross-cultural Teams, Stakeholder Management, Systems Thinking

Experience

Engineering Manager - Cloud Platform, Awin Global – Barcelona, Spain Aug 2024 – present

Lead the Cloud Platform and DevOps teams and own the platform strategy, the datacenter-to-AWS migration and FinOps.

- Lead the datacenter-to-AWS migration of 1,400+ VMs. I ran vendor selection and the contract, and got phase one fully funded through AWS MAP, saving $150k+. Datacenter exit is planned for 2027.
- Hired **8 engineers** since September 2025, from junior to senior and across several European countries, to rebuild the team after a re-org and staff DevOps in every product domain.
- Led the project that made **GitHub Actions** the company's CI/CD standard, with about 50 engineers contributing. Golden pipelines cut new-service setup by 16 hours, use OIDC short-lived credentials and include an emergency deployment mode for when GitHub is down.
- Wrote a GitHub Actions pipeline that lets engineering teams get **GitHub Copilot** access themselves.
- Wrote the **You Build It, You Run It** operating model and the SRE strategy, and re-implemented incident management. Moved DevOps from a central team that had become a bottleneck into the product domains, with two enablement engineers per domain, and took the team through it in 1:1s and a ways-of-working workshop that produced the prescriptive guide for enablement engineers.
- Led the FinOps initiative which accumulated a monthly saving of **$84k+** across AWS and Datadog on $3.5M+ of annual spend, and domain-level forecasting cut budget variance from 20% to 3%.
- In the DX survey, engineering teams' rating of DevOps/CPE rose from 68 to **82**, and my team's rating of me and P&T from 62 to 73. Focus Time, Supporter of the Week and psychological-safety check-ins helped lift Peakon engagement from 7.2 to 8.3.

Cloud DevOps Manager, Awin Global – Barcelona, Spain Jan 2024 – July 2024

Restructured the team and how it worked to remove bottlenecks and make ownership clear, using Team Topologies.

- Mapped the bottlenecks, wrote a new department charter and, together with Engineering, reorganized into **DevOps**, **Cloud Platform** and **IT Ops**.
- Managed 3 senior DevOps engineers in Germany and Italy and finished the **AWS landing zone** so other teams could adopt it.
- Replaced Docker Desktop with open-source tools, saving **$18,000** a year.
- Hired the two managers who lead the new sister teams.

Security Architect, AVIV Group – Hamburg, Germany July 2022 – Jan 2024

Built a self-service Secure Product Lifecycle (SPLC) for AVIV's cloud-native products.

- Launched the **SPLC** and grew it into a self-service program with a dynamic questionnaire and standard risk reports. Delivery got faster without extra headcount.
- Completed **50+** application security assessments in 9 months and found 80+ distinct risks.
- Cut recurring findings by fixing them once at platform level, from preventive SCPs to automated responses and alerts.
- Ran an ongoing security awareness program for Product & Tech, with talks, architecture guidelines and a newsletter, built into teams' existing meetings.
- Tracked cycle time, completion rate and developer satisfaction, and used them to improve the program and report to leadership.

Security Officer Germany, AVIV Group – Hamburg, Germany Feb 2022 – Jan 2023

Led security for the merger integration and the AWS foundations, improving control coverage and audit readiness.

- Ran security integration for the German businesses, aligned controls with CIS and group standards, and supported internal audits.
- Designed and built the security part of the **AWS landing zone**, covering IAM Identity Center, a Transit Gateway hub-and-spoke network, and central security logging and monitoring.
- Hardened the AWS setup further with SCPs, Prowler and AWS Security Hub.

Cyber Security Specialist, immowelt GmbH – Hamburg, Germany Oct 2021 – June 2022

Set up the company's first cybersecurity function and built security and privacy into the development process.

- Improved cloud security with custom automation and Prowler scans across **100+ AWS accounts**.
- Introduced a NIST-based maturity model for product teams and aligned the RCA process with the product lifecycle.
- Ran a company-wide Capture-The-Flag program to build security awareness.

DevOps Engineer, immowelt GmbH – Hamburg, Germany Aug 2015 – Sept 2021

Brought DevOps practices to the company and rebuilt the main product on AWS.

- Replaced the Puppet config-management monolith with modular **Ansible**, and ran a temporary Docker platform on DC/OS Mesosphere to improve stability and let us split out microservices.
- Ran and automated 3 datacenters with 50+ physical Linux and Windows servers (KVM, OpenNebula, Hyper-V).
- Pushed for DevOps and you-build-it-you-run-it during the all-in AWS rebuild of the property search, so teams could deliver on their own.
- Built **GitLab CI/CD** with Terraform (later CDKTF), with environment standards and ephemeral stacks for faster testing and releases.
- Wrote production code in Java, Python and TypeScript, plus Angular and React frontends.
- Shipped the AWS-native MVP of the **Search Engine Result Page (SERP)**, immowelt's main property-search product, in 8 months, and the full feature set 9 months later.

IT-Support, Goodgame Studios – Hamburg, Germany Feb 2014 – July 2015

IT support at a fast-growing games company, including the Windows Server infrastructure.

- 2nd and 3rd level support for **800+ users** across two locations.
- Automated routine tasks with PowerShell and AutoIt scripts.

Projects

- **Play40** (play40.app), an online version of Ecuador's national card game. Built alone on serverless AWS (AppSync, Lambda, DynamoDB, Terraform) with a Next.js frontend.

Education

tectumHOME GmbH, Apprenticeship IT Systems Electronics Technician – Hamburg, Germany Sept 2011 – Jan 2014

State Trade School G18, Hamburg, Higher Education Entrance Qualification – Hamburg, Germany Apr 2014

Languages

- **German** (native) · **English** (fluent) · **Spanish** (working proficiency)

Interests

- **Cycling**, **Muay Thai**, **specialty coffee** (trained others in brewing), and **learning languages**.